



THE FAMILY SAFETY PLAYBOOK

NIGERIA EDITION

When danger comes, will your family be ready?



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The Family Safety Playbook — Nigeria Edition.

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INTRODUCTION

The new reality of safety in Nigeria

We have to begin honestly, because pretending all is well is itself a kind of danger. The Nigeria many of us grew up in — where you knew everyone on your street, trusted the road to the village, and never thought twice about the school gate — has changed. None of us caused that change, and no amount of worrying will undo it. But seeing it clearly, with calm eyes, is the very first thing that keeps a family safe.

Consider what a single recent year looked like. The National Bureau of Statistics' Crime Experience and Security Perception Survey — the most comprehensive study of its kind, drawn from households across all 36 states and the FCT and covering May 2023 to April 2024 — estimated about **2.2 million kidnapping incidents** in that year alone, with families paying roughly **₦2.23 trillion in ransom**. Of the households touched by kidnapping, around **65% paid**, at an average of about **₦2.67 million** each. The same survey counted close to **52 million crime incidents** in all. These are not abstractions or foreign headlines. They are our neighbours, our colleagues, the people we sit beside in church and at the mosque.

And the pressure has not eased. Independent trackers at SBM Intelligence recorded at least **4,722 people abducted in 997 incidents** in the year to June 2025 — concentrated in the

North-West, but with no part of the country truly untouched. Into 2026, civic groups warned that **more than 1,000 Nigerians had been abducted in the first weeks of the year**, and both local and international advisories kept listing kidnapping, armed robbery, carjacking, and banditry among the risks of ordinary life.

But — and this matters every bit as much — the picture is not all darkness, and it is very far from hopeless. In that same stretch of time, Nigerian banks reported that **digital-payment fraud fell by about 51%, from ₦52.26 billion in 2024 to ₦25.85 billion in 2025**. That drop did not happen by luck. It happened because people and institutions got smarter, more careful, and harder to fool. And that is the entire premise of this playbook: **awareness works. Preparation works. The ordinary family is anything but helpless.**

This is not a book about fear

Let us be clear from the start about what this guide is — and what it is not.

It is not here to frighten you. Fear is loud and, in the end, useless. It freezes you at the exact moment you most need to think clearly, and when it is left to simmer it quietly shrinks your whole life, until you are afraid of your own road, your own gate, your own phone. That is no way for anyone to live, and it is not what safety means.

This guide is about the calm opposite of fear: **awareness, layers, and a plan you have actually practised**. It takes the

same systems that security professionals, soldiers, and protection experts rely on — systems that can sound intimidating or far removed from everyday life — and translates them into plain, practical habits any of us can use. It does not matter whether you live in a gated estate or a face-me-I-face-you compound, whether you move around in your own car or board a danfo every morning. The principles are the same, and they are all within your reach.



The single idea behind this whole book: in a real crisis, none of us rises to the occasion — we fall back to what we have already practised. Everything in these pages exists to give you and your family something calm, simple, and rehearsed to fall back on.

The one thing every criminal needs

Here is the insight that ties the entire playbook together. Whether it is an armed robber, a "one chance" gang, a kidnap crew, a burglar, or a faceless online fraudster, they are all after the same three things — and they cannot succeed without them: **surprise, isolation, and control.**

- **Surprise** — catching you unaware, before you have any chance to react.
- **Isolation** — getting you alone and cut off from help, witnesses, or an exit.
- **Control** — once they have your attention, your gate, your money, or your panic, dictating everything that happens next.

Take away even one of these and most attacks simply fall apart. **Awareness** destroys surprise. **Layers** and good daily habits deny isolation. A **calm, practised plan** strips away their control. You do not need to be a fighter, wealthy, or armed to be safe. You only need to be a harder, less predictable target than the situation around you — and that, every one of us can become.

Who this playbook is for

This is written for the ordinary Nigerian family that wants to live fully and freely — to travel, do business, raise children, build a home — without handing easy opportunities to the few who would prey on them. It is for the parent planning the school run, the driver on the long interstate road, the young professional taking a ride home after dark, the trader protecting her day's earnings, the family putting up their first gate. Our circumstances differ; the calm, layered approach belongs to all of us equally.

What's inside, and how it fits together

The playbook moves from the everyday to the rare, and from preventing trouble to responding well if it ever finds you. Each module stands on its own, but read together they form one connected system:

1. **Module 1 — Situational awareness:** seeing trouble early, before it ever reaches you. The foundation everything else is built on.

2. **Module 2 — Daily movement safety:** the commute, traffic, ATMs, ride-hailing, and "one chance" — protecting you where you are most exposed.
3. **Module 3 — Home & estate security:** building the layers that make a criminal study your home and decide to move on.
4. **Module 4 — Child & school safety:** code words, safe pickups, and protecting our children at the gate, online, and beyond.
5. **Module 5 — Vehicle & travel safety:** the car, the checkpoint, and the open road, from the daily drive to the long interstate journey.
6. **Module 6 — If the worst happens:** calm, clear survival and response guidance for kidnap and ransom — the chapter we pray you never need.
7. **Module 7 — Digital & financial safety:** protecting your money, your identity, and your family from scams, fraud, and online predators.
8. **Module 8 — Your Family Emergency Plan:** the capstone that pulls every habit, code word, and contact into one plan your whole household has practised.

After the modules come your **Quick-Reference Cards** — one-page checklists for the moments you will not have time to read — and an **Emergency Contacts Directory** to fill in and keep close.

How to use this playbook

- **Read it once, calmly, all the way through** — ideally long before you ever need it. Knowing the whole picture helps each piece fall into place.
- **Start with Modules 1 and 2.** Awareness and daily movement protect you every single day, wherever you live.
- **Do the checklist at the end of each module** before moving on. Reading changes what you *know*; the checklists change what you *do*.
- **Fill in the worksheets.** They quietly turn this from a book about safety into *your family's own* safety plan.
- **Build your Family Emergency Plan (Module 8) within your first week** — even a rough version. You can refine it later.
- **Keep the Quick-Reference Cards** on your phone, your fridge, and in your car, so they are within reach in the few seconds that truly count.
- **Bring your family in.** A plan only one person knows is half a plan. Share it — gently and calmly, never as a fear lecture — with your spouse, your children, and the people who help keep your home.



One last word before we begin. Choosing to read this is not paranoia — it is care made practical. It is love, turned into something useful. You cannot control everything that happens in this country, but you can quietly make your family a great deal safer than it was yesterday. That work starts on the very next page.

CHAPTER 1

Situational Awareness

Seeing trouble before it reaches you

If you learn nothing else from this playbook, learn this module. Almost every other chapter is about *reacting well*. This one is about never needing to react at all — because awareness is what lets you step out of danger before it closes around you.

Here is the single most important truth about serious crime in Nigeria: **most attacks are not random**. Armed robbers, "one chance" gangs, and kidnap crews are running a business, and like any business they reduce their risk before they act. They choose targets who look unaware, predictable, and isolated. They watch. They test. *Then* they move. Every step they take before the attack is also a chance for you to notice — and noticing is free.

Think of awareness not as fear or paranoia, but as a quiet background habit, like checking your mirrors when you drive. You are not expecting a crash. You are simply keeping enough information flowing that, if something goes wrong, you already have somewhere to go.



The core principle: Criminals need three things to succeed — *surprise, isolation, and control*. Awareness destroys surprise. The rest of this playbook helps you deny them isolation and control. Take away surprise and you have already won most of the fight.

A familiar pattern (and how awareness breaks it)

Picture a common Lagos morning. A woman leaves her estate at exactly 7:10 every weekday, turns right, and joins the same go-slow at the same junction, phone pressed to her ear, window half down. For three days, a man on an okada has been parked near her gate when she comes out. She half-noticed him on day one, forgot by day two, and on day three didn't look up at all.

Nothing in that story is dramatic — and that is exactly the point. The danger was never hidden. It was *routine, predictable, and unobserved*. Now rewind it: on day two she clocks the same okada, feels a small unease, varies her time and route on day three, mentions it to her gateman, and the watcher — who needs an easy, predictable target — quietly moves on to someone else. That is situational awareness working the way it is supposed to: boring, invisible, and life-saving.

The Awareness Ladder

Security professionals worldwide use a simple mental model first popularised by firearms instructor Jeff Cooper, often

called the "colour code." You do not need the colours – you need the four gears. The goal is to live in **Gear 2**, drop to **Gear 1** only at home behind locked doors, and shift up *fast* when something triggers you.

Gear	State of mind	What it looks like in daily life
1 — Switched off	Unaware, absorbed, oblivious	Head down in your phone, earbuds in both ears, lost in thought. <i>Only acceptable at home with doors locked.</i> This is where victims are made.
2 — Relaxed but aware	Calm, head up, taking in surroundings	Your default the instant you step outside. You notice who is around, where the exits are, which cars are near you. Not tense — just present.
3 — Alert	A specific thing has caught your attention	That same okada again. A man who matched your pace. You focus on it, identify your exits, and start forming a plan. Most situations resolve here.
4 — Act	The threat is real; you move	You leave, call for help, drive to safety, or make noise. No hesitation, no "let me be polite first."

The entire skill is **catching yourself in Gear 1 and climbing back to Gear 2**. Build small triggers into your day: every time you unlock your car, walk through a gate, or step off a keke, take one breath and scan. Over a few weeks it becomes automatic.

How criminals choose a target: the "marking" phase

Before a planned kidnapping or home invasion, there is almost always a period of watching — Nigerians call it being "**marked**." The crew learns your routine: when you leave, when you return, who lives with you, how many guards, which gate, whether you travel alone. The more predictable you are, the easier you are to plan around.

This surveillance is also the criminal's most exposed moment — and your best early-warning window. Watch for:

- **The same face, car, or okada** appearing near your gate, office, or your children's school run more than once, especially at the times you come and go.
- **People loitering** near your gate with no clear reason, or "workmen," "meter readers," or "officials" no one actually called.
- **Strangers asking questions** — of your gateman, neighbours, shop owners, or children — about your movements, your schedule, who owns which car, or when "oga" travels.
- **A parked car with people just sitting inside** near your home or a regular stop, particularly at odd hours.
- **Repeated silent or wrong-number calls**, or a "delivery" you never ordered — sometimes used to confirm you are home or to get your gate open.

The other danger zone: transitions

Most attacks happen not in open movement but at **transition points** — the few seconds when you are slowing down, stopping, or distracted. The highest-risk moments in an ordinary day are:

- **Arriving home and waiting for the gate to open** — you are stationary, boxed in, and predictable. This is the classic kidnap and "follow-home" robbery moment.
- **Leaving home in the morning** at the same time each day.
- **Getting in or out of your car** at a shop, ATM, church, or school.
- **Stuck in go-slow** with windows down and attention on your phone.

For each of these, the fix is the same: shift to Gear 2 *before* you arrive, keep space and an exit, and never sit unaware. (Module 3 covers the gate-arrival drill in detail; Module 5 covers the car.)

Trust the feeling: your instinct is data

That small, wordless sense that *something is off* is not superstition — it is your brain noticing a pattern faster than it can explain it. Security experts call it the body's early-warning system, and the single biggest mistake good people make is **overriding it to avoid seeming rude**.

You do not owe a stranger your politeness at the cost of your safety. If a situation feels wrong — a man who is suddenly too close, a "helper" you didn't ask for, a lift that feels off — you

are allowed to leave, lock the door, refuse, or walk into a shop, with no explanation and no apology. The worst case if you're wrong is mild awkwardness. The worst case if you ignore it is the reason this playbook exists.

The 3-turn follow test

If you suspect a vehicle or okada is following you on foot or while driving, confirm it calmly before reacting:

1. **Make three deliberate, ordinary turns** — for example, three right turns that bring you back toward where you started, or turns onto streets you would have no normal reason to take.
2. **If the same vehicle stays with you through all three**, treat it as a follow. Do not speed, panic, or confront.
3. **Drive to safety, not home.** Head for the nearest police or military checkpoint, fuel station, bank, or busy, well-lit public place. Call someone and say where you are. *Never lead a follower to your gate* — that hands them exactly the isolation they want.



Say this on the phone (out loud, even to voicemail): "I think I'm being followed. I'm on [road], heading to [the filling station / police post] at [landmark]. The car is a [colour, type, plate if visible]. Stay on with me." Saying it aloud calms you, creates a record, and can deter a watcher who realises you've clocked them.

Awareness in everyday Nigerian settings

On foot / at markets and bus stops. Keep your phone in your pocket, not your face. Carry your bag on the side away from the road to deter okada snatch-and-grab. Pick the busier, better-lit path even if it's slightly longer. At a bus stop, stand back from the kerb and near other people.

Okada, keke, and "drop" cabs. Before you enter, glance at who else is inside and whether it feels normal. A half-empty "drop" with two or three "passengers" who insist you squeeze in is the classic "one chance" setup — wave it on and take the next one. (Full ride-hailing and "one chance" guidance is in Module 2.)

Banks and ATMs. Scan before you approach; don't use a machine in a lonely or dark spot; never count cash in the open. Anyone who follows you out of a bank deserves your full attention.

Online — the invisible surveillance. Today much "marking" happens on a phone screen. Posting your new car, your travel dates, your children's school or uniform, or live "I'm at..." locations does a criminal's homework for them. Awareness now includes your digital footprint. (Module 7 goes deep on this.)

Teach your whole household to see

Awareness only protects a family if the *whole* family practises it. Make it normal dinner-table talk, not a fear lecture.

- **Children:** teach them, simply, to notice if "the same person keeps showing up," to never go with anyone without the family code word (Module 4), and to run toward people and noise — into a shop, a crowd — if they feel scared.
- **Spouse and adult relatives:** agree that anyone can call a stop with no debate. If one person feels off, the family acts first and discusses later.
- **Gateman, driver, and domestic staff:** they are your front line and a common target for questioning. Brief them never to share your schedule, travel plans, or movements with anyone, and to report strangers asking questions or loitering. (Vetting them properly is covered in Module 3.)

A 30-second daily drill

Awareness is a muscle. Train it with this simple game until it's reflex:

- **The exit habit:** each time you enter a place — a restaurant, bank, church, shop — find the exits within 30 seconds. You'll never need most of them. The one time you do, you'll already know.
- **The recall game:** occasionally, look away and ask yourself, "What colour was the car that just passed? Who is standing behind me?" If you can't answer, you've slipped into Gear 1. Climb back to Gear 2.

- **The baseline read:** in any place, notice what "normal" feels like. The person who is too still, too interested in you, or out of place against that baseline is the one worth a second look.



Optional support tools. A small personal alarm (loud enough to startle and draw attention) for those on foot, and a basic dashcam for drivers, both make you a harder, less appealing target.  **Get the gear:** a personal safety alarm and a dashcam are both in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

Common myths that get people hurt

- *"It won't happen to me / on my street."* Predictability, not neighbourhood, is what marks a target. Awareness is cheap insurance regardless of where you live.
- *"Being aware means being paranoid and tense all day."* The opposite — true awareness is calm and quiet. Panic is what happens when you *weren't* aware and got surprised.
- *"If I'm polite and cooperative, nothing bad will happen."* Politeness toward a stranger who triggers your instinct is exactly the reflex criminals rely on. Be courteous to people you trust; be safe around everyone else.
- *"My gateman/guard handles security."* Guards help, but they can be deceived, distracted, or questioned for information. Your own awareness is the layer no one can switch off.

Module 1 checklist

- ☐ Default to "Gear 2" (relaxed but aware) every time you step outside
- ☐ Build a one-breath scan into daily triggers: gate, car, keke, doorway
- ☐ Vary your daily routes and departure times where you can
- ☐ Keep your phone out of your face when walking, arriving, or in traffic
- ☐ Treat the gate-arrival moment as high-risk: approach aware, never boxed in
- ☐ Learn and be ready to use the 3-turn follow test
- ☐ Trust your instinct — give yourself permission to leave, refuse, or lock up
- ☐ Brief household and staff never to share your schedule or movements
- ☐ Agree a household word that means "something is wrong, act now"
- ☐ Run the 30-second exit and recall drills until they're automatic

Worksheet — My awareness map

Fill this in for your own life; it turns this module from theory into a personal plan.

My most predictable moments (same time/place daily):

My highest-risk transitions (gate, school run, regular ATM):

Two ways I can make my routine less predictable this week:

My "drive to safety" points on routes I use most (police post, filling station, busy junction):

My household "act now" code word:

Who I will brief this week (spouse, children, gateman, driver):

CHAPTER 2

Daily Movement Safety

Commuting, traffic, ATMs & ride-hailing

Module 1 taught you to see trouble. This module is about the place you are most likely to meet it: **on the move**. For the average Nigerian family, the daily commute, the school run, the quick dash to an ATM, and the long go-slow home are where exposure is highest — not because movement is rare, but because it is *routine, predictable, and distracted*.

The good news is that the same small habits protect you across every kind of trip, whether you drive your own car, take Bolt, or squeeze into a danfo. This module gives you those habits, broken down by how you actually travel.



The movement rule of three: before any trip, ask — *Who knows where I'm going? What's my exit if this goes wrong? Am I in Gear 2?* If you can answer all three, you've already removed most of the risk.

Know the threats you're actually facing

"One chance." We all know the name — it's an organised robbery run from a moving vehicle, usually a car or keke. A car or keke that already contains the gang hails you as an ordinary passenger; once you're in and moving, the doors effectively lock, and you are robbed, beaten, or driven off. It peaks at **rush hour** in Lagos and Abuja, when everyone is

tired, rushing, and grateful for any ride. Abuja hotspots repeatedly named in reporting include **Banex Junction, CBN Junction, Airport Road, Central Area, Garki, Nikon Junction, Kubwa Expressway, Mabushi, Zuba, and the Gwagwalada-Lokoja road**. A November 2025 diplomatic security advisory specifically flagged a rise in "one chance" vehicle robberies and kidnappings across Abuja and Lagos, including a commercial-taxi driver arrested for repeated robberies and assaults on passengers, *especially women*.

Express kidnapping. Increasingly, "one chance" escalates into what security professionals call **express kidnapping**: rather than a long ransom negotiation, the victim is held for a few hours and driven between ATMs, forced to withdraw the daily maximum and to transfer money or hand over banking credentials. It usually ends "when the money runs out" — when daily withdrawal limits are hit or the bank blocks the account. Crucially, experts note these incidents are **usually non-violent unless the victim resists** — which shapes how you respond (see below).

A familiar scenario

It's 7:40 pm at a busy Lagos bus stop. A cab slows, already holding two quiet "passengers," and the driver waves you in with a friendly "enter, last seat!" You're tired, it's getting dark, and the next bus is nowhere. The pull to just get in is enormous — and that pull is exactly what the gang is selling.

The person who goes home safe is the one who notices the small wrong notes — too eager a driver, passengers who

won't meet your eye, a car that's oddly empty for rush hour — and simply says "no, I dey wait for person" and steps back. There is no prize for being the polite passenger. Wave it on and take the next one.

Ride-hailing (Bolt, Uber, inDrive) — your safest option, used correctly

App-based rides are generally safer than street cabs *because they create a record* — but only if you use the safety features. In 2025, Bolt led Nigerian e-hailing on safety with **mandatory passenger verification and a driver-scoring system**; Uber and inDrive offer their own in-app safety tools. Use them every time:

- **Match before you enter:** confirm the **plate number, car model/colour, and driver's photo** against the app. If any one doesn't match, do not get in — cancel and rebook.
- **Share your live trip** with a trusted contact by default, on every ride. Let the driver see you do it.
- **Stay on-app, always.** Never accept "let's go offline," "cancel and pay cash," or a side deal. Off-app trips are invisible — no GPS trail, no record of the driver, no support if something goes wrong. This is the single most important ride-hailing rule.
- **Sit in the back, behind the front passenger seat** — it gives you the widest view and two exit doors.
- **Watch the route** on the map. If the driver makes unexplained detours or stops to "pick a friend," speak up, call someone, and end the trip at the next safe, busy place.

- **Trust the cancel button.** A poor rating, a vehicle that doesn't match, or a driver who feels off is reason enough to cancel before entering. You lose nothing.

Danfo, keke, okada & street cabs

Not everyone can afford an app ride for every trip. If you use public or informal transport:

- **Avoid near-empty "drop" cabs** that already hold two or three passengers pushing you to join — the classic "one chance" setup.
- **Board at recognised parks and stops**, not from a vehicle that pulls up uninvited and hurries you in.
- **Glance inside first.** If the mood feels off, the passengers won't look at you, or the door handles/windows look tampered with, wait for the next one.
- **Keep your bag closed and on the far side** from the window or road to deter snatch-and-grab by passing okada.
- **Sit near the door** where it's safe to exit, and stay in Gear 2 — phone away, eyes up.

ATM safety (and the express-kidnap link)

ATMs are a magnet for both ordinary robbery and express kidnapping, because they turn a victim into instant cash.

Official travel advisories are blunt: **use ATMs in public, well-lit places during daylight hours only.**

- Choose machines **inside a bank branch, mall, or busy filling station** over a lonely standalone booth, especially after dark.
- **Scan before you approach.** If someone is loitering or a parked car is watching the machine, walk on.
- **Cover the keypad**, take your cash and card quickly, and **never count money in the open** — sort it later, somewhere safe.
- **Vary which ATMs you use** and at what times; don't make the same machine at the same hour part of your fixed routine.
- Be aware of daily withdrawal limits as a *safety* feature, not just an inconvenience: they cap how much an express-kidnap gang can extract.

In your own car: traffic, go-slow & junctions

Our go-slows and junctions are where snatch-and-grab and "follow-home" attacks happen most, simply because that's where you sit stationary and boxed in.

- **Doors locked, windows up** whenever you're stopped or crawling — the standard advice in every official Nigeria travel advisory.
- **Leave a car's length of space ahead** of you in traffic so you can always pull out or around; never let yourself be sandwiched bumper-to-bumper.

- **Keep phones, bags, and laptops out of sight** — on the floor or in the boot, never on the passenger seat where a smashed window nets an instant prize.
- **Be most alert at junctions, traffic lights, and toll/checkpoints**, the natural stopping points where attackers operate.
- **Combine this with Module 1's 3-turn follow test** and the gate-arrival drill in Module 3 — your home approach is the highest-risk stop of all.
-  **Get the gear:** a dashcam, steering lock, and in-car emergency kit are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

If a robbery or express-kidnap happens anyway

You cannot always avoid it. If you are caught:

- **Comply. Do not resist.** Every major safety authority agrees: hand over the phone, the cash, the car. Express kidnappings are usually non-violent *unless the victim fights*. Your life is worth more than any object.
- **Stay calm and unremarkable** — follow Module 1's "be a person, not a target" guidance and Module 6's detailed response steps.
- **Don't make sudden moves or reach for things** without telling them what you're doing.
- **Afterwards, get to a safe, busy place, then call 112** and your bank's emergency line to freeze cards and report any forced transfers.



Say this if you must speak to attackers: "Okay, okay — I'm cooperating. Everything is here, take it." Keep your hands visible, your voice low and steady, and do exactly what's asked. Compliance is a strategy, not surrender.



Module 2 checklist

- ☐ Run the "rule of three" before every trip: who knows, what's my exit, am I in Gear 2
- ☐ Always verify plate + car + driver photo before entering a ride-hailing car
- ☐ Share your live trip with a trusted contact, every ride
- ☐ Never go off-app or switch to a "cash, app off" ride
- ☐ Refuse near-empty "drop" cabs with insistent passengers; board only at known stops
- ☐ Use only daytime, busy, well-lit ATMs; cover the keypad; never count cash openly
- ☐ Vary your ATMs and withdrawal times
- ☐ Doors locked, windows up, valuables hidden, gap ahead in traffic
- ☐ If robbed, comply fully — then get safe and call 112 and your bank



Worksheet — My movement plan

My three most-used routes and their "drive to safety" points:

My default ride-hailing app + is live-trip sharing turned on?

The trusted contact I share live trips with:

The two safest ATMs I'll use (bank/mall/busy station):

My bank's card-block / fraud emergency number (save it now):

One predictable movement habit I'll change this week:

CHAPTER 3

Home & Estate Security

Turning your home into a hard target

Your home should be the one place you can fully relax — the one place Module 1 said it's safe to drop into "Gear 1." That is only true if the layers around you are doing the watching for you. This module shows how to build those layers so that a criminal studying your street quietly decides your house is too much trouble, and moves on to an easier one.

One principle runs through everything here: **no single barrier stops a determined intruder — but layers do.** Your gate, your lights, your locks, your camera, and your household's habits are not each meant to be unbeatable. They are meant to cost an intruder *time and noise* — and time and noise are exactly what a burglar or invasion crew cannot afford. They want to be in and out, unseen and unheard. Every layer that slows them or raises the chance of being noticed makes your home a worse deal than the next one.

And for most families, this is the threat you are most likely to face. Property offences — theft, burglary, and fraud — make up roughly **half of all reported crime in Nigeria**, and international safety advisories list home invasion and burglary among the country's most common crimes, with the risk climbing after dark. Even prominent, well-resourced Nigerians have been killed in residential robberies, with

armed-robbery cases still making national headlines into 2026 — a sober reminder that this is not only a "rough area" problem.



The home-security mindset: think like the person casing your house. Stand at your own gate after dark and ask, *"If I wanted in, where is the weak point — the dark corner, the climbable wall, the napping gateman, the window hidden behind the generator?"* Every weakness you find is one you can fix before someone else finds it for you.

A quiet evening, two endings

It's 9 p.m., NEPA has taken the light, and the street is dark except for the hum of generators. Two men have watched one particular gate for a few evenings. They've clocked that the security light never comes on, that the gateman naps around this time, and that an overgrown tree shades the back wall.

Now picture the same house built in layers: a motion light snaps on as they approach, a clearly visible camera with battery backup watches the gate, the wall is clear and topped, and a dog stirs inside. Suddenly nothing about that house is worth the risk when an easier one sits two streets away. That is the whole game — you win not by fighting, but by being the house they decide to skip.

Layer 1 — The perimeter: wall, fence, and the darkness

Your outer boundary is your first warning line. The goal is simple: make it hard to cross, and impossible to cross *unseen*.

- **Kill the dark.** Most intruders rely on shadow. Fit **motion-activated lights** on every dark side, especially the back and any blind corner. Because of constant outages, put at least some on **solar or inverter backup** so a blackout doesn't quietly switch your security off. 🛒 **Get the gear:** solar motion lights and floodlights are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.
- **Remove the climbing aids.** Trim trees and hedges near the wall, and move anything stackable — blocks, bins, ladders, a parked generator, a water tank — away from the fence line. A surprising share of "break-ins" are really someone stepping up on something you left there.
- **Top the wall** with something that genuinely deters climbing, and check that it is unbroken all the way round.
- **Walk it at night, not just by day.** A wall that looks solid at noon can hide a dark, unwatched corner at 9 p.m. Do this walk-through once and you'll spot weak points you've strolled past for years.

Layer 2 — The gate: where most trouble is invited in

The hard truth about home invasions here is that the gate is often *opened*, not forced. The crew talks, tricks, or threatens

their way in. So your gate policy matters even more than the gate itself.

- **One rule above all: verify before you open.** No gate opens for an unscheduled "visitor," "electricity official," "meter reader," "delivery," or even "police" until their identity and reason are confirmed — by phone, by a known contact, or by you personally. Genuine officials will wait; criminals count on your politeness and your hurry.
- **Beware the uniform.** Impostors pose as officials, and there have even been cases of serving officers dismissed for robbery and kidnapping. A uniform is a claim, not a clearance — verify anyway.
- **Brief your gateman like the front line he is.** He should never open on his own judgement for strangers, never share your movements or schedule with anyone, and always alert you to people loitering or asking questions. (His own vetting is covered below — he is also a prime target for questioning.)
- **See before you open.** A simple **video doorbell or intercom** lets you check who is there without exposing yourself at the gate.  **Get the gear:** video doorbells and gate intercoms are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.



Visitor verification script (give this to your gateman and household): *"Please wait outside. I'll confirm and come back to you."* Then check: Who are you? Which company or station? Who called you, or who are you here to see? Call that office or person on a number you already have — never a number the visitor gives you. No verification, no entry.

Layer 3 — Doors, windows, and the gate-arrival drill

If someone gets past the perimeter, the building itself is your next layer.

- **Harden the entry points.** A **reinforced main door** plus a security/grille door, with burglar-proofing on accessible windows, turns a ten-second entry into a noisy, time-eating struggle most intruders abandon.
- **Lock up by habit, not by mood.** Many burglaries simply exploit an unlocked door or window. Lock doors and ground-floor windows every night and whenever the house is empty — even "for five minutes."
-  **Get the gear:** security doors, deadbolt locks, and window reinforcement are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

The gate-arrival drill (promised in Module 1). Arriving home is the single most dangerous moment in your day — you are

stationary, predictable, and your gate is opening. Make this routine automatic:

1. **Approach in "Gear 2."** As you near home, put the phone down and scan the street. Is anything parked oddly, anyone loitering, anyone who seemed to follow you in?
2. **Don't stop dead at a closed gate.** Time your arrival so the gate is opening as you reach it, or call ahead so you are not sitting still and boxed in. If something feels wrong, *drive past* and loop back — never sit waiting.
3. **Pull fully in, then watch your tail.** Make sure no one slips in behind you before the gate closes. Only relax once it is shut.

Layer 4 — Detection: cameras and alarms that survive NEPA

Cameras and alarms do two jobs: they *deter* (a visible camera makes yours the house to skip) and they *record* (vital if anything ever happens). Home-security tech is now mainstream — adoption is rising fast, with millions more households expected to own CCTV by the end of the decade — and prices have fallen sharply.

- **Cover the gate and approaches first;** those are the angles that matter most.
- **Solve the power problem.** A camera that dies with the light is useless exactly when you need it. Put cameras and alarm on **solar or inverter/battery backup** so they keep running through outages — this is the one detail most people get wrong.

- **Add a loud alarm, or even a dog.** Noise is the enemy of a quiet break-in; both buy you warning and scare off the casual intruder. 🛒 **Get the gear:** solar CCTV kits, inverter/UPS backup, and alarm systems are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

Layer 5 — The safe core: your last, locked layer

If someone ever does get inside, your family needs one room they can retreat to and hold.

- **Choose one lockable inner room** (often the master bedroom) as your safe core, and reinforce its door if you can.
- **Stock it:** a **charged phone or power bank**, your written emergency numbers (112 and your local police line), a torch, and a way to make noise.
- **Agree the rule:** at the household "act now" code word (Module 1), everyone goes to the safe core, locks the door, and calls for help — they do **not** go to investigate.
- 🛒 **Get the gear:** panic buttons, door security bars, and power banks are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.



If intruders are already inside: do **not** confront them over property. Get everyone to the safe core, lock it, stay quiet, and call 112. If a clear escape outside is safer, take it. As in Module 2, **comply over cash** — every safety authority agrees your family's lives are worth more than anything in the house.

The inside-job risk: vetting staff and artisans

A painful share of home invasions begin with information from someone trusted — a current or former staff member, an artisan who "came to fix something," or someone they spoke to. This is not a reason to treat your staff as enemies. It is a reason to vet properly and to limit what any one person knows.

Before hiring any domestic staff, driver, gateman, or live-in help:

- ☐ Collect a clear photo, a valid government ID, and their **NIN**
- ☐ Get a verifiable home address and a **guarantor** who has their own ID and contact
- ☐ Call at least **two** previous employers or references — and actually speak to them
- ☐ Keep a copy of all of the above on file

Once they are working with you:

- ☐ Don't let any one person learn your **full** routine, alarm codes, cash locations, and travel plans
- ☐ Change locks or codes and revoke access **whenever staff leave** — every time
- ☐ Supervise artisans and "repairmen" while they are inside; don't let them roam or photograph the house
- ☐ Remind all staff never to discuss your movements, schedule, or valuables with anyone outside

Bringing it together: defense in depth

No single layer is perfect — and that is exactly the point. The dark corner you light, the gate rule you enforce, the window you burglar-proof, the camera that survives NEPA, the room you can lock: each one buys time and noise, and together they make your home the hard target a criminal walks past. You don't need all of it at once. Start with the cheapest, highest-impact fixes — lighting, the gate rule, locking up, and staff vetting — and build from there.

Module 3 checklist

- ☐ Walk your full perimeter **at night** and fix every dark or weak spot
- ☐ Clear climbing aids (trees, blocks, bins, tanks) away from the wall
- ☐ Put security lights, cameras, and alarm on **solar/inverter backup**
- ☐ Set one strict gate rule: **verify before opening, always** — even for "officials"
- ☐ Give your household and gateman the visitor-verification script
- ☐ Reinforce doors and burglar-proof accessible windows; lock up nightly by habit
- ☐ Practise the gate-arrival drill until it's automatic
- ☐ Vet every staff member with photo, ID, NIN, address, guarantor, and references
- ☐ Change locks or codes whenever staff leave

- ☐ Choose and stock a lockable safe room, and teach the "go there, don't investigate" rule



Worksheet — My home security audit

Walk your home and compound once with this list; it turns the module into a concrete to-do.

The darkest or weakest point on my perimeter right now:

Climbing aids I need to move away from the wall:

My gate rule, written in one sentence for my gateman:

Doors/windows that still need reinforcing or burglar-proofing:

Are my camera and alarm on power backup? If not, the plan:

My safe room, and what still needs to go into it:

Staff whose references/NIN I have not yet verified:

CHAPTER 4

Child & School Safety

Protecting our children at the gate and beyond

There is no fear like the fear of something happening to your child, and no Nigerian parent needs to be told the threat is real. The wave of school abductions that returned at the end of 2025 made that painfully clear: in a single month, gunmen took **25 schoolgirls from a government school in Kebbi State** — killing the vice-principal — and **315 people, 303 students and 12 teachers, from St Mary's Catholic School in Papiri, Niger State**, one of the worst mass abductions in our history. All of the Papiri captives were eventually freed by Christmas — but the danger did not end with them.

If anything, it has hardened in 2026. In January the UN's human-rights office warned of a fresh surge in child abductions, a decade on from Chibok, and civic groups now say **more than 1,000 Nigerians have been kidnapped since the start of the year**. The raids have kept coming — and have spread well beyond the usual northern flashpoints: an orphanage school attacked in late April (its pupils freed in early May), **more than 50 children, some as young as two, seized from three schools in Mussa, Borno State**, and **39 students and seven teachers taken from schools in Oyo State** in the South-West, a region once assumed to be safer. Set against the **more than 1,500 schoolchildren abducted since the 2014 Chibok kidnapping** and the roughly **19 million**

Nigerian children already out of school, the picture is sobering – which is exactly why a calm, practised family plan matters now more than ever.

This module is not here to deepen that fear. It is here to turn it into a plan. And the first thing a clear plan does is separate two very different threats, because they call for very different responses.



Two different threats, two different plans.

1. Mass school abductions – the headline attacks, where armed groups storm mostly rural boarding schools in the North-West and North-Central and take dozens or hundreds at once for ransom. If your child boards in a high-risk area, this is the threat to plan around, and most of what helps is about *the school's* security and your choices about where and how they board.

2. Everyday child-targeting – the quieter, far more common danger most city families actually face: a child lured or snatched at the school gate, on the walk home, or at the market, often by someone using a trick, and sometimes by someone the family already knows. This is the threat your daily habits, your code word, and what you teach your child can defeat directly.

Most of this module is about threat 2, because it is the one within your control every single day – but we cover both.



The mindset: whether it's a lone trickster or a crew watching a school, predators rely on two things — *predictability* and *misplaced trust*. A child who always leaves the same gate at the same time with no plan, raised to obey any adult without question, is the easy target. Everything below attacks those two weaknesses.

"Mummy sent me" — two endings

School closes, and a friendly man approaches a child at the gate: "*Your mummy is not feeling well, she sent me to carry you home. Come, let's go quickly.*" The child who has only ever been taught to respect elders hesitates, then goes — and no one at the gate thinks twice.

Now the same moment in a family that uses a code word. The child asks, "*What's the password?*" The man fumbles, has no answer, and the child turns and walks straight back to a teacher. The "uncle" quietly disappears. One small word turned a polished trick into nothing.

The family code word — your single most powerful tool

If you do only one thing in this module, do this. A **family code word** is a secret word or short phrase that any adult must know before your child will go anywhere with them.

- **The rule is absolute: no word, no going.** No exceptions — not for a "nice uncle," not for someone in uniform, not even for someone the child half-recognises.

- **Choose it well.** Pick something easy for your child to remember but that never comes up in everyday talk — avoid "football" or your area's name. A slightly odd pairing like "blue elephant" works.
- **Keep it small.** Only you, your child, and the one or two adults you would ever actually send should know it. Change it the moment it slips out.
- **Add a second, "rescue" code word** your child can use to tell you — by call or text — "I'm not comfortable, come now, no questions." Agree that using it never gets them into trouble. Children stay quiet when they fear being scolded; this removes that fear.

The school run: pickup, drop-off, and the gate

The school gate is a transition point, exactly like the home gate in Module 3 — a predictable place and time when your child is exposed.

- **Give the school a short, written authorised-pickup list** with photos, and insist they release your child to no one outside it without phoning you first.
- **Make the school earn your trust on this.** A school that will hand your child to any confident adult who shows up is a school you must push to change — or reconsider.
- **Vary the routine where you can** — who collects, and at what time — so no watcher can set their plan to your clock.
- **Mind the walk.** If your child walks or takes transport, set a fixed, busy route, a buddy to walk with, and known stops

only. No shortcuts through quiet places, and no boarding a vehicle that pulls up uninvited.

-  **Get the gear:** child GPS trackers/smartwatches and personal safety alarms are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

Teaching your child — power without fear

Children are safest when they feel capable, not terrified. Teach these as simple rules and games, not horror stories:

- **The code-word rule** above, practised until it's automatic.
- **"You are allowed to say no to a grown-up."** Gently undo the "obey every adult" reflex — a safe adult will never need your child to disobey you or keep a secret from you.
- **Run toward people and noise** — into a shop, a market, a crowd — never away into somewhere quiet.
- **Make a scene.** It is completely okay to scream "*You are not my parent!*" or "*Help!*" as loudly as possible. Predators need quiet and cooperation; noise ruins both.
- **Memorise two parent phone numbers** and how to dial **112**.
- **Name their safe adults** in advance — a teacher, a shopkeeper, a market woman, a security officer — people to run to if lost or scared.
- **Know the common tricks** without dwelling on fear: the "your mummy/daddy is hurt and sent me," the "help me find my puppy," the free gift or sweet, the "let me take your photo." A grown-up asking a child for help is itself the warning sign.

The uncomfortable truth: the people around your child

This is the part no one likes to discuss, but it matters most. A painful share of harm to children comes not from masked strangers but from someone the family knows and trusts — a lesson teacher, a driver, a house-help, a "family friend," an "uncle." Saying this is not paranoia, and it is not an accusation against everyone; it is simply where the risk really lives.

- **Vet everyone who has access to your child** — lesson teachers, drivers, nannies, domestic staff — with the same rigour Module 3 applied to home staff: photo, ID, NIN, address, guarantor, and real references you actually call.
- **Avoid unnecessary one-on-one isolation** between your child and any single adult, online or in person.
- **Keep the door open** — literally and emotionally. A child who knows they can tell you anything without being blamed or disbelieved is far safer than one who fears your reaction.
- **Watch for sudden changes** — a child who suddenly fears or avoids a particular person, or whose mood or behaviour shifts sharply, is telling you something. Listen.

Online discipline — don't do the predator's homework

Much of today's "marking" happens on a screen, and children are the most over-shared people in any family. Every post is information.

- **Don't post your child's school name, uniform, full name, class, or daily routine**, and never tag live "just dropped them at..." locations.
- **Watch the background.** A birthday photo can reveal a school crest, a house number, or a landmark.
- **Turn off geotagging** on photos of your children, and tighten who can see your posts.
- **Mind the school WhatsApp and class groups** — know who is actually in them, since they often carry names, photos, and schedules of every child. (Module 7 goes deeper on this.)

Mass-abduction risk: choosing and questioning the school

If your child attends — or you are considering — a boarding school in a higher-risk state, treat security as a first-tier question, not an afterthought. Be honest about day vs boarding in such areas, and weigh location carefully. Then ask hard questions, and keep asking, because the answers should improve over time.

Questions to ask your child's school (and keep asking):

- ☐ Is the perimeter secure, and who actually controls the gate during school hours?
- ☐ Is there a written emergency/lockdown plan, and have staff and students drilled it?
- ☐ How exactly do you verify who collects each child, and do you enforce a pickup list?
- ☐ How quickly, and by what method, will you alert parents in an incident?
- ☐ How do you vet teachers, drivers, and non-teaching staff?
- ☐ For boarding schools: what are the night-time security arrangements, and who is on duty?

If your child goes missing — the first hour



Act immediately — the "wait 24 hours" idea is a myth.

The first hour is the most important. The moment you cannot account for your child, raise the alarm; do not wait to "see if they turn up."

- **Raise the alarm at once** and pull in everyone nearby — school, gateman, neighbours, estate security — to start checking immediately.
- **Call 112 and go to the nearest police station** to report. Be ready with a **recent photo, exactly what they were wearing, and who they were last seen with.**
- **Check the usual places** in parallel — friends' homes, the regular route, shops, anywhere they go.

- **Keep one phone line free** in case your child or anyone with information calls.
- **If anyone makes contact demanding ransom**, switch immediately to Module 6 — stay calm, demand proof of life, and involve the police.

Module 4 checklist

- ☐ Agree a family **code word** for pickup, and drill it with your child
- ☐ Agree a second "**rescue**" **code word** for "come now, no questions"
- ☐ Give the school a written, photo **authorised-pickup list** and confirm they enforce it
- ☐ Set a fixed, busy route for any walk or commute, with a buddy and known stops
- ☐ Teach your child: say no to adults, run toward people, make noise, call 112
- ☐ Name and point out your child's **safe adults** to run to
- ☐ Vet every teacher, driver, and helper with access to your child
- ☐ Keep communication open so your child will always tell you things
- ☐ Stop posting school name, uniform, routine, and live locations online
- ☐ For boarding in higher-risk areas, vet the school's security and weigh day vs boarding
- ☐ Know the missing-child first hour: act now, call 112, photo + last-seen details



Worksheet — My child safety plan

Fill this in with your child where age-appropriate; it turns the module into a real, shared plan.

Our family pickup code word:

Our "come now, no questions" rescue word:

Adults on my authorised-pickup list (with photos given to the school):

My child's safe route and known stops:

My child's named safe adults (teacher, shopkeeper, security):

Two phone numbers my child has memorised:

People with regular access to my child I still need to vet:

One thing I will stop posting about my child online:

CHAPTER 5

Vehicle & Travel Safety

The car, the checkpoint, and the open road

For many of us the car feels like the safest place we own — a locked, private box that takes us door to door. The truth is more complicated. Your vehicle protects you in some moments and exposes you in others, and the difference is almost always *where* and *when* you are driving, and *how well* you planned the trip.

There are really two very different journeys to think about. The first is the **daily city drive** — the school run, the office, the market, the go-slow home — where the main risks are snatch-and-grab at junctions, "follow-home" robbery, and the gate-arrival moment (all covered in Modules 2 and 3). The second is the **interstate journey** — the long road to the village, another city, or the airport — where the picture changes completely, and the risk becomes armed robbery and kidnapping on lonely stretches of highway.

That second risk is real and current. Our highways, especially notorious corridors like the **Abuja-Kaduna expressway**, have seen armed gangs stop vehicles to rob and abduct travellers; as recently as January 2026 the army rescued **eleven kidnap victims** in a late-night operation on that very road. Official travel advisories through 2026 list **carjacking, roadside banditry, and kidnapping** among the most common violent crimes nationwide, and several states are flagged "do not

travel" outright. The steady advice across all of them is the same: **plan hard, travel by day, and never resist a robbery.**

And there is a quieter danger we tend to forget while worrying about bandits: **the road itself.** Crashes — from reckless overtaking, potholes, bad tyres, and night driving — injure and kill far more Nigerian families in an ordinary year than armed gangs do. A complete travel plan has to treat both.



The travel mindset: a safe journey is mostly won *before you turn the key.* The decisions that protect you — when to travel, which road, who knows your plan, is the car ready — are all made at home, calmly, the day before. Once you are on a lonely highway, your options are already mostly set. Plan the trip, and the trip almost plans itself.

A journey, two endings

A family needs to travel to a town three hours away. In the first version, they leave "whenever we're ready" — which turns out to be 3 p.m. — in a car low on fuel and running on a tyre that should have been changed last month. No one outside the car knows the route. Darkness catches them on a lonely stretch, the fuel runs low, and they're forced to crawl along looking for a station, exactly where they are most exposed.

Now the same trip, planned. They decide the night before to leave at first light, fill the tank and check the tyres in the

evening, and send their route and expected arrival time to two relatives with a promise to check in on arrival. They travel in daylight, keep moving, and are sitting down to lunch at their destination before the dangerous hours begin. Same family, same road — a completely different level of risk, decided entirely by choices made at home.

Before you travel — the planning that does most of the work

- **Ask whether the trip is necessary, and when.** For long trips through higher-risk areas, weigh whether a flight, a different date, or a safer route is worth it. If you must go, **timing is everything.**
- **Travel by day, always.** Leave early so you arrive well before dark. The most dangerous hours on any highway are dusk to dawn — for both bandits and crashes. Avoid night road travel outside city centres entirely.
- **Get current road intelligence.** Roads change week to week. Ask people who ply the route regularly, or contacts in the area, which stretches are safe right now and which to avoid. A road that was fine last year may be a black spot today.
- **Prepare the vehicle the day before.** Service it, **fill the tank** (never set off low — a fuel stop in the wrong place is a vulnerable moment), and check tyres, spare, and tools. A breakdown on a lonely road is one of the most dangerous traps there is.
- **Tell someone, and set check-ins.** Share your **route, who's travelling, and your expected arrival time** with at least

one person who will raise the alarm if you go silent. Agree a simple "we've arrived" message and a halfway check-in.

- **Don't advertise.** Keep signs of wealth out of view — no flashy jewellery or expensive devices on the seats. A modest-looking car and traveller draw less attention.
- **For higher-risk routes, travel in convoy** with another vehicle where you can, and never take "shortcuts" through quiet, unknown roads to save time.

Hardening the car itself

A few one-time investments make your vehicle a harder target and a faster one to recover:

- **A GPS tracker** lets your car be located and recovered if it's stolen or driven off — vehicle tracking has become standard for Nigerian car owners for exactly this reason.
- **Anti-shatter window film** — makes glass far harder to smash quickly at a junction or in a snatch attempt, buying you precious seconds.
- **A dashcam** records the road and any incident, deterring some attackers and providing evidence after a crash or robbery.
- **Keep doors on central lock** and windows up as a default, and keep a basic emergency kit (water, torch, warning triangle, first-aid, power bank) in the boot.
-  **Get the gear:** GPS vehicle trackers, anti-shatter window film, dashcams, and in-car emergency kits are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book.

On the road — habits that keep you moving

- **Doors locked, windows up, valuables out of sight** — on the floor or in the boot, never on the seat.
- **Keep a gap ahead of you** in slow traffic so you can always pull out and are never boxed in. This is your single most useful driving habit.
- **Keep moving where you safely can.** Attackers need you stopped. Anticipate junctions and go-slows, and don't sit idle and distracted.
- **Don't let the tank drop below half** on a long trip, so you're never forced to stop in a bad place.
- **If you think you're being followed,** use Module 1's 3-turn test and drive to the nearest police or military post, filling station, or busy public place — **never to your home.**
- **Be patient with other drivers.** Road-rage confrontations escalate fast and can turn dangerous; let the reckless driver go.

Checkpoints — telling the real from the fake

Checkpoints are a normal part of our roads, and most are genuine. A few are not. Knowing how to handle both calmly matters.

- **At a genuine checkpoint:** slow down early, turn down loud music, put on your interior light at night, keep your hands visible, and be polite. Have your papers accessible. Don't argue or make sudden movements.
- **Read the setup.** Genuine security checkpoints are usually at logical, semi-busy points, with proper uniforms,

identifiable vehicles, and other traffic around. Be wary of a "checkpoint" on a lonely stretch, with mismatched uniforms, or where you're the only car.

- **If something feels wrong and it's safe to do so**, don't stop in an isolated spot — continue at a steady, non-provocative pace to the next populated area, known checkpoint, or filling station, and call for help. Trust the instinct Module 1 taught you.

The danger we underestimate: crashes

For most families, the highest *everyday* travel risk isn't a gang — it's a crash. Reckless overtaking, speeding, potholes, worn tyres, and exhausted night driving cause a steady toll the FRSC battles year-round. Protect against it:

- **Seatbelts on — everyone, every trip**, and proper seats for young children.
- **Don't speed, and don't let your driver speed.** Build in enough time that no one feels rushed.
- **Avoid night driving** — poor lighting, fatigue, and broken-down trucks make it doubly dangerous.
- **Avoid clearly overloaded or recklessly driven commercial vehicles**; wait for a better one.
- **Take breaks on long trips** to stay alert, and never drive exhausted.

If your car breaks down

A breakdown on a lonely road is both a safety and a security risk. If it happens:

- **Get the car as far off the road as you safely can**, and put on hazard lights and your warning triangle.
- **In a risky area, stay inside with the doors locked** and call someone you trust for help, rather than standing exposed.
- **Be cautious of "helpful" strangers** who appear too quickly; accept help only from people or services you can verify.
- This is exactly why a full tank, good tyres, and a charged phone before you leave matter so much.



If you're carjacked or stopped by armed men: do **not** resist. Every major safety authority is unanimous — give up the car, the phone, the bag without hesitation. Keep your hands visible, move slowly, say what you're doing before you do it, and avoid eye-contact challenges. A vehicle is replaceable; you are not. If you are taken, switch to Module 6.

✓ Module 5 checklist

- ☐ Travel by day; never drive lonely highways after dark
- ☐ Check current route intelligence before long or rural trips
- ☐ Service, fully fuel, and check tyres the day before you travel
- ☐ Share your route, passengers, and ETA, and agree check-ins

- ☐ Fit a tracker, anti-shatter film, and a dashcam; keep an emergency kit aboard
- ☐ Doors locked, windows up, valuables hidden, gap ahead in traffic
- ☐ Keep the tank above half; keep moving where safe
- ☐ Use the 3-turn test; drive to safety, never home, if followed
- ☐ Handle checkpoints calmly; don't stop in lonely spots that feel wrong
- ☐ Seatbelts on, no speeding, no night driving, take breaks
- ☐ If carjacked or confronted, comply fully — your life over the car



Worksheet — My travel plan

Fill this in before any major road trip; it turns the module into a pre-journey ritual.

My trip: date, departure time (aim for first light), and arrival deadline before dark:

My route, and the stretches I've been warned to avoid:

Who I've shared my route + ETA with, and our check-in plan:

Vehicle ready? (service, full tank, tyres, spare, kit):

Security fitted? (tracker, anti-shatter film, dashcam):

My "drive to safety" points along this route:

CHAPTER 6

If the Worst Happens

Kidnap, ransom & getting your people home

This is the chapter we all pray never to need. Read it once, calmly, while your mind is clear — because if that day ever comes, no one in the house will be thinking straight, and you will want to have already decided what to do. Everything in Modules 1 to 5 exists so that you never reach this page. But preparation is not pessimism. A family that has quietly agreed who does what, and who to call, is a family that can act in the first frightening minutes instead of freezing.

Let us be honest about where we stand, without losing our heads over it. Kidnapping in Nigeria has hardened into an organised, profit-driven business. The most detailed independent tracking we have, from SBM Intelligence, recorded at least **4,722 people abducted in 997 incidents** in the year to June 2025, with at least **762 killed**; kidnappers demanded roughly **₦48 billion** and collected about **₦2.57 billion**. The year before that, other trackers counted more than **7,500 abductions and over 1,000 deaths**. And here is the hard truth every family must sit with before it ever negotiates: **paying is not a guarantee**. In one widely reported case in mid-2025, captors killed dozens of hostages *even after* a ransom had been paid. None of this is meant to frighten you — it is meant to make sure that if you ever act, you act with clear eyes.



This module is calm, general survival guidance — **not** legal or professional negotiation advice. Two things you must know up front. First, under a 2022 law, paying a ransom is technically a crime in Nigeria — a minimum 15-year term, with the death penalty for kidnappers where a victim dies — though it is rarely enforced and most affected families still pay. Second, serious cases are beyond any guide: the moment you can, bring in the police and, where possible, professionals who do this for a living. Use what follows to survive the first hours and to think clearly, not as a substitute for expert help.

Know which situation you are in

Not every "kidnap" is the same, and the right response depends entirely on which one you are facing:

- **Express kidnapping** — held for a few hours, driven between ATMs and made to withdraw and transfer money; it usually ends when the money runs out. (Covered in Module 2.) Comply — your life over your account.
- **Targeted kidnap-for-ransom** — you or a relative is marked, taken, and held for days or weeks while a ransom is negotiated. This is where the rest of this module focuses.
- **Mass, highway, or school abduction** — armed groups take many people at once, usually on rural roads or from schools. Prevention lives in Modules 4 and 5; the survival advice below still applies.

- **Virtual ("fake") kidnapping** — no one has actually been taken at all. A caller claims to be holding your loved one and pressures you to pay *immediately*. This scam is rising fast, and we deal with it on its own below — because the worst thing you can do is pay for a kidnap that never happened.

The first job in any frightening call is to work out, calmly, which of these you are really dealing with.

If you are the one taken — your only job is to come home

Your single goal in captivity is survival. Not bravery, not escape heroics, not winning — just staying alive until you are released or rescued. Almost everyone taken for ransom is worth far more to their captors alive than dead, and that quiet fact is on your side.

- **Do not fight armed captors once they have you.** At the very first instant, if you can break away and run toward people and noise with a real chance of escape, take it. But once you are outnumbered and held, resistance gets people hurt. Comply.
- **Control your breathing and your fear.** Slow, deep breaths. Panic clouds judgement; calm keeps you thinking. Tell yourself: *my people are working to bring me home*.
- **Be a person, not a problem.** Be quiet, polite, and cooperative. Follow their rules. Don't argue, don't challenge, don't stare them down, don't make threats. The more human and unremarkable you are, the safer you stay.

- **Protect your body.** Eat and drink what you safely can, sleep when you can, and move or stretch a little to stay strong. If you take essential medication, say so early and calmly, and ration it.
- **Protect your mind.** Hold on to routine, to prayer or faith if it is yours, and to small mental anchors — count the days, picture your family, keep your spirit up. People endure remarkable things this way.
- **Watch and remember, quietly.** Without ever being obvious, note voices, names, accents, the journey, sounds, how many captors. It may help later — but never let them catch you watching.
- **Don't reveal your true wealth, and don't make big promises.** Talking up your money, your big job, or "my family will pay anything" only raises your price and lengthens your ordeal. Stay modest and calm.



If they force you to speak, call home, or record a "proof of life": stay calm and do as instructed. Keep it short — say your name and that you are alive, and follow their script. If you can do it safely, without obvious risk, work in one small, true detail only your family would recognise; it helps them know the message is genuinely from you. Do not improvise, argue, or try hidden signals that could anger your captors.

If a loved one is taken — the family's first hour

The first hour is chaos and terror. The families who come through best are the ones who slow down and follow a plan instead of reacting blindly.



Act — do not freeze, and do not "wait and see." The moment you are sure someone has been taken, move. But equally, do nothing rash, public, or impulsive in those first raw minutes — every action from here should be deliberate, not panicked.

- **Appoint one calm point-person.** Choose the steadiest adult — often not the closest, most emotional relative — to lead, handle the calls from captors, and keep everyone coordinated. One voice, one plan.
- **Decide on the police, and call 112.** Reporting is your right. Ask for the **Special Anti-Kidnapping Squad** and, where relevant, the **Multi-Agency Anti-Kidnap Fusion Cell**, and reach your state police command. Many families hesitate here out of fear — weigh it seriously, but know the official channels exist and that 112 is the national line.
- **Start a written log at once.** Record every call: the number, the time, the voices, the exact words and demands. This is vital for the police and for keeping track when emotions are running high.
- **Go silent on social media.** Do not post, do not announce, do not "please share." Public appeals invite scammers, raise your "price," and can endanger the victim. Keep it tight to those who truly need to know.

- **Set up one dedicated phone and line** for contact with the captors — kept charged, answered only by the point-person, with someone always near it.
- **Gather the basics** the police will need: a recent photo, what the person was wearing, and where, when, and with whom they were last seen.

Talking to kidnappers — the basics

This is not professional negotiation, and you should hand it to the police or experienced negotiators wherever you can. But you may have to hold the line in the early hours, so understand the principles:

- **It takes time — and time is on your side.** These negotiations stretch for days or weeks. Patience is not weakness; it keeps the victim alive and brings the demand down. Never rush.
- **Always demand proof of life — before anything else.** Insist on speaking to the victim, or ask a question only they could answer (agree this question *now*, as a family — see the worksheet). Never discuss money, and never pay a kobo, until you have confirmed the person is alive and genuinely held by the people you are talking to. This one step also exposes the fake-kidnap scams below.
- **Stay calm, humble, and respectful.** One steady voice. Don't shout, insult, threaten, or mention the police to the captors. Don't antagonise them — keep the victim human in their eyes.
- **Buy time, and never reveal your true means.** Don't name a figure first; let them state a demand, then negotiate

down slowly and honestly. Plead your real limits — most families genuinely cannot pay what is first demanded. Talking up your money only drives the price higher.

- **Hold on to the proof-of-life check** throughout, and especially before any handover is ever discussed.



On the call — do: stay calm, speak slowly, ask for proof of life, show willingness to cooperate, say you need time to "gather small money."

Don't: shout, threaten, insult, mention the police, name a large sum first, or promise far more than you have.

One sober word on paying. It is illegal, it funds the next abduction, and — as families have learned at terrible cost — it does not guarantee release. Yet most affected families, with no good options, still pay. There is no clean answer here. That is exactly why involving the police or professional responders, people who have walked this road before, matters so much. Do not carry this decision entirely alone.

The fake-kidnap (virtual kidnapping) scam — don't pay for a crime that never happened

A fast-growing trick needs no real victim at all. A caller phones in a panic, claims to be holding your child, spouse, or parent, plays screaming or a cloned voice, and demands you transfer money or buy airtime *this minute* — while ordering you to "stay on the line, don't hang up, don't call anybody." Security agencies, including the FBI, now warn that criminals use **altered photos and even AI-generated voices** as fake

"proof of life," and Nigerian police have arrested people for **staging kidnaps to extort relatives**. The whole scam runs on panic and speed. Defeat it by slowing down:

- **Stay calm and stall.** The pressure to act *this second* is itself the scam. Say you need a moment; genuine handlers expect back-and-forth.
- **Quietly verify.** While you keep them talking, use another phone — or have someone beside you — to call or message the "victim" and the people they are with. Most fake kidnaps collapse the instant you reach your loved one safe and well.
- **Ask your proof-of-life question** — the one only the real person could answer. A scammer will dodge, bluff, or get angry.
- **Never transfer money or send airtime under pressure** to a number you cannot verify.
- **Agree a family safe word now** — it ties straight into your Module 4 code word and your Module 8 plan — so you can confirm a genuine emergency in seconds, and unmask a fake one just as fast.

After release — the part we forget

Coming home is the beginning of recovery, not the end of the story.

- **Get a medical check** straight away, even when there are no visible injuries.
- **Expect a hard emotional aftermath** — fear, anger, guilt, sleeplessness, flashbacks — for the survivor *and* the family.

This is a normal response to something deeply abnormal. Be patient, talk, and seek counselling or trusted support; watch the children especially closely and gently.

- **Debrief the police** with everything you and the survivor remember, while it is still fresh.
- **Tighten your security.** Sadly, a released victim can be marked again. Revisit Modules 1 to 5, change routines and anything that was compromised, and rebuild your layers.
-  **Get the gear:** power banks and document safes/pouches for your go-bag and records are in the Recommended Safety Gear appendix at the back of this book (see also Module 8).

Module 6 checklist

- ☐ Agree your family's **proof-of-life question** — one only the real person could answer
- ☐ Name the calm **point-person** who would lead and handle any captor calls
- ☐ Save **112**, your state police command, and note the Anti-Kidnapping Squad / Fusion Cell
- ☐ Agree that the family will **go silent on social media** if anyone is taken
- ☐ Know the survival rules: comply, stay calm, be a person, protect body and mind
- ☐ Know the negotiation basics: demand proof of life, buy time, never reveal your true means
- ☐ Learn the **fake-kidnap** tells — panic, "don't hang up," instant transfer — and how to verify

- ☐ Agree a **family safe word** to confirm a real emergency (and expose a fake one)
- ☐ Plan for **after**: medical check, emotional support, police debrief, tighter security



Worksheet — My kidnap-response plan

Fill this in calmly now, with your family. If you ever need it, you will be grateful it is already done.

Our proof-of-life question (and the answer only we would know):

Our designated calm point-person:

Numbers saved — 112, state police command, trusted contact:

Our family safe word for "this is a real emergency":

The one dedicated phone we would use for contact:

Who we would turn to for professional or community help:

Digital & Financial Safety

Protecting your money, identity & family online

Up to now this playbook has guarded your body, your home, and your movements. This module guards something criminals are coming after just as hard — and far more quietly: **your money, your identity, and your family's presence online.** You will never see this attacker's face. There is no okada at your gate, no checkpoint, no masked man. There is only a phone call that sounds official, a link that looks real, an investment that sounds too good, or a stranger who slid into your child's DMs. And the damage can empty in minutes what took years to build.

Here is the encouraging part, and it runs through this whole guide: the same calm habits that keep you safe on the road keep you safe online. **Slow down. Verify on a separate channel. Never act under pressure.** Urgency is the fraudster's only real weapon — and patience is yours.

The numbers tell a hopeful story wrapped around a warning. Nigerian banks lost about **₦25.85 billion to digital-payment fraud in 2025 — down 51% from ₦52.26 billion in 2024**, with reported cases falling to roughly **67,515**, the fifth straight year of decline, helped by BVN–NIN identity checks. That is real progress. But the warning is just as real: **Lagos alone accounts for about 63% of fraud**, and in early 2026 the Central Bank issued public alerts about fraudulent links,

emails and messages, calling the scale of digital-payment scams "catastrophic" and pushing banks toward stronger authentication. The thieves haven't given up — they've gone smarter, more personal, and increasingly powered by AI.



The one rule that defeats almost every scam: *no genuine request ever requires you to act this second.* A real bank, a real official, a real relative in trouble will all survive you hanging up and calling back on a number you already trust. The moment someone forbids you to verify — "don't hang up," "don't tell anyone," "send it now" — you are no longer talking to a friend. You are talking to the scam.

A quiet afternoon, two endings

A trader gets a call. The voice is calm, professional, and knows her name and even her bank: "Madam, this is your bank's security team. We've detected fraud on your account. To reverse it, read me the code we just sent — quickly, before they finish the transfer." Her phone buzzes with a real-looking OTP. Heart pounding, grateful for the "help," she reads it out. Within minutes her account is swept clean.

Now the same call, to someone who knows the one rule. She listens, then says, "Thank you — I'll call my bank myself." She hangs up, dials the number on the back of her card, and learns there was never any fraud team, never any problem — until she nearly created one. Same call, same pressure, completely different ending. The only difference was a pause and a hang-up.

Threat 1 — The fake bank call, OTP & USSD trap

This is the most common way ordinary Nigerians lose money, and it almost always relies on you handing over the keys. The fraudster, posing as your bank, NIBSS, a switching company, or even "EFCC," creates panic — a blocked account, a suspicious transfer, an expiring BVN — and rushes you into revealing what they cannot get on their own.

- **Never share an OTP, PIN, CVV, or full card number — with anyone, ever.** No real bank or staff member will ever ask for these. An OTP is the last lock on your money; reading it aloud is opening your own safe for a thief.
- **Be deeply suspicious of any USSD code a "helper" tells you to dial.** Some strings forward your calls (enabling SIM-related fraud) or authorise transfers. If you didn't initiate it, don't dial it.
- **Hang up and call back on a number you already have —** the one on your card, your bank's app, or its official website. Never the number that called you, and never a number *they* give you.
- **Treat unexpected "you've been credited" alerts with suspicion.** A common market scam is a fake credit alert (a spoofed SMS or a doctored screenshot) used to collect goods or "refund" an overpayment. Confirm money has truly landed *in your own banking app* before you release anything.

Threat 2 — SIM-swap: when they steal your phone number

This is the quiet one that empties accounts overnight, and regulators say it is on the rise. A fraudster gathers enough of your details (often from your own oversharing) to convince your network to move your number onto *their* SIM. Suddenly your line goes dead — and every OTP, every alert, every "forgot password" code now goes to them.

- **Your first red flag is sudden loss of service** — no calls, no texts, "SIM not registered" — for no reason, especially after odd calls or messages. Treat an unexplained dead line as an emergency: contact your network and bank at once from another phone.
- **Set a SIM/network PIN** and ask your provider what extra port-out or SIM-swap protection they offer.
- **Move beyond SMS codes where you can.** Use an *authenticator app* or in-app approval for banking and email rather than SMS OTPs, so a stolen number alone can't unlock your accounts.
- **Lock down the email tied to your bank** with its own strong password and app-based two-factor — it's the master key to everything else.

Threat 3 — Phishing links, fake apps & mobile malware

Not every attack needs to talk to you. A single tap can do the damage.

- **Don't click links in unexpected SMS, WhatsApp, or email** — "confirm your BVN," "your account will be deactivated," "claim your reward," "track your parcel." Go to the bank or service directly through its official app instead.
- **Only install apps from official stores**, and check the developer and reviews. Fake banking and loan apps that harvest your details and contacts are a growing problem; in 2026 Nigerians were warned specifically about mobile-banking malware.
- **Beware predatory loan apps** that demand access to your contacts and photos, then harass and "name-and-shame" you. Read what permissions an app wants before you grant them.
- **Keep your phone locked** with a strong PIN plus biometrics, keep software updated, and never leave banking apps open on an unlocked phone.

Threat 4 — "Too good to be true": Ponzi and investment scams

This is the heartbreak that wipes out life savings, and 2025 gave us the hardest lesson yet. The **CBEX crypto platform**, which lured Nigerians with AI-hyped promises of doubling their money, **collapsed in April 2025**, with reports of **hundreds of millions of dollars — by some accounts over a**

billion — lost across Nigeria and Kenya before investors found their funds frozen. The EFCC recovered only a portion and arrested promoters; many families got nothing back. CBEX was not the first, and it will not be the last.

- **If it promises high, guaranteed, fast returns, it is a scam.** Real investments carry risk and never "guarantee" to double your money in weeks. That promise is the warning.
- **Watch for the tells:** pressure to "join before it closes," rewards for recruiting others, vague or buzzword-heavy explanations ("AI trading," "forex bot"), difficulty withdrawing, and slick Telegram or WhatsApp hype groups.
- **Verify before you ever pay.** Check that the company and product are registered with the SEC and CBN; an entity "licensed" only by its own glossy app is not licensed at all.
- **Be wariest when it comes from someone you trust.** These schemes spread through churches, families, and friend groups — good people unknowingly recruiting good people. Their endorsement is not verification.



The money mantra: *If it sounds too good to be true, it is.* Slow, boring, verifiable, and registered beats fast, exciting, and "exclusive" every single time. No real opportunity is destroyed by you taking a day to check it.

Threat 5 — Romance and "relationship" scams

These prey on the heart, and they are patient — a scammer may invest weeks or months building love and trust before

the first request for money: a medical bill, a stuck shipment, a plane ticket, a "business" emergency. West Africa is so associated with this trade that the warning signs are well documented.

- **Be cautious with anyone who professes strong feelings fast, yet always has a reason they can't meet or video-call** clearly.
- **Never send money, gift cards, airtime, or crypto** to someone you have not met in person — no matter the story or how real the documents look.
- **Reverse-image-search their photos** and watch for inconsistencies in their story. Loneliness is not foolishness — these manipulators are skilled, and they target widows, the recently divorced, and the isolated.

Threat 6 — The new frontier: AI deepfakes & voice cloning

This is where digital fraud and the kidnap-fear of Module 6 meet — and why we end on it. Criminals can now clone a familiar voice from just a few seconds of audio (a WhatsApp voice note, a video, a status) and generate fake images or even video. In 2026 the UN and the World Economic Forum both warned that AI is supercharging impersonation scams worldwide.

- **The cloned-voice emergency call.** "Mummy, I've had an accident, send money now" — in a voice that sounds exactly like your child or sibling. This is the digital twin of the virtual-kidnap scam in Module 6, and the defence is

the same: **stop, hang up, and reach the real person on their own number.**

- **Use your family safe word** (the one set in Modules 4 and 6). A cloned voice cannot know it. One agreed word unmasks the most convincing fake in seconds.
- **Distrust urgency and secrecy in any "it's me" message,** even a video. Polished and personal is no longer proof. Verification on a separate channel is.

Threat 7 — Your digital footprint: don't do the criminal's homework

Everything in Module 1 about being "marked" now happens first on a screen. Your posts are free intelligence — for kidnappers pricing a ransom, burglars timing your absence, and scammers building rapport.

- **Don't broadcast wealth, big purchases, or cash.** The new car, the renovation, the "God did it" windfall — each one paints a target.
- **Never post live travel or "I'm at..." locations.** Share the trip *after* you're safely home, not while your house sits empty. Turn off photo geotagging.
- **Tighten your privacy settings** so only people you know see your posts, and prune followers you can't actually place.
- **Mind what your children and staff post** about your home, cars, schedule, and travels too — your whole household shares one footprint.

Protecting our children online — the predator you can't see

The digital threat to children is real enough that Nigeria acted on it: the National Assembly passed a **Child Online Protection Bill at the end of 2025**, and the NCC, NAPTIP and UNICEF all run active child-online-safety programmes.

Predators no longer need the school gate of Module 4 — they reach in through games, social apps, and DMs, often posing as another child, grooming patiently, then moving to threats and sextortion.

- **Keep devices in shared spaces**, especially for younger children, and know which apps and games they use and who they talk to there.
- **Set the golden rule**: the online code from Module 4 applies on screens too — no real friend asks you to keep secrets from your parents, send photos, or meet in person.
- **Watch for grooming and sextortion signs**: a child who is suddenly secretive about their phone, anxious after going online, or in contact with someone older they "met" in a game. Sextortion — tricking a child into a compromising photo, then blackmailing them — is rising and thrives on a child's fear of being blamed.
- **Keep the door open**. As in Module 4, a child who knows they can tell you *anything* without being scolded is your strongest protection. Make clear they will never be in trouble for reporting something that scared them.
- **Use parental controls and privacy settings**, but treat them as a backup to conversation, not a substitute for it.



Get the gear: kid-safe routers are in the **Recommended Safety Gear** appendix at the back of this book
(parental-control apps come from the Play Store / App Store, not Jumia).

If you are defrauded — move fast

Speed decides how much you recover. The moment you realise something is wrong:

- **Call your bank's official fraud line immediately** to freeze the account and block cards. Most banks have a 24/7 line and an in-app "block/freeze" option — find yours and save it *now*, before you need it.
- **Change passwords and PINs** for your bank, email, and anything else exposed, from a device you trust.
- **If it's a SIM-swap**, contact your network at once to reclaim your number alongside your bank.
- **Report it.** Lodge a formal complaint with your bank (get a reference), and report serious fraud to the **EFCC** and the **Nigeria Police Force National Cybercrime Centre**. Reporting builds the case and can help recovery.
- **Keep evidence:** screenshots, numbers, accounts, transaction references, and a written timeline — exactly like the call log in Module 6.

Module 7 checklist

- ☐ Lock every device with a strong PIN **plus** biometrics, and keep software updated

- ☐ **Never** share an OTP, PIN, CVV, or BVN — and never dial a USSD code a "helper" gives you
- ☐ Hang up on "bank/official" calls and call back on a number you already trust
- ☐ Set a SIM/network PIN; treat a sudden dead line as a possible SIM-swap emergency
- ☐ Move banking and email to app-based two-factor instead of SMS where you can
- ☐ Don't click links in unexpected messages; install apps only from official stores
- ☐ Treat any "guaranteed high returns" offer as a scam; verify SEC/CBN registration first
- ☐ Never send money to an online-only "partner" you've never met in person
- ☐ Agree and use a **family safe word** to defeat cloned-voice and fake-emergency calls
- ☐ Stop posting wealth, live locations, and travel; tighten privacy for the whole household
- ☐ Keep kids' devices in shared spaces, know their apps, and keep the "tell me anything" door open
- ☐ Save your bank's fraud line, the EFCC, and the Cybercrime Centre now, before you need them



Worksheet — My digital safety plan

Fill this in today; most of it takes ten minutes and can save you everything.

My bank's 24/7 fraud / card-block number (saved in my phone):

Have I switched banking & email to app-based two-factor? If not, when:

My SIM/network PIN is set (yes/no), and my port-out protection option:

Our family safe word for "it's really me" emergencies:

One thing I will stop posting publicly (wealth, location, travel, kids):

My children's apps/games and who they talk to — do I actually know?

One "too good to be true" offer I will walk away from or verify this week:

CHAPTER 8

Your Family Emergency Plan

One plan your whole household has practised

Everything in this playbook so far has been a layer of protection. This final module is the thread that ties all those layers into one thing your whole family can pick up and use on the worst day of your life. Because here is the quiet truth behind every emergency: **in a real crisis, nobody rises to the occasion — you fall back to what you have already practised.** Fear floods the mind, the hands shake, and clear thinking is the first thing to go. A family that has talked through its plan, agreed who does what, and drilled it twice will act in those first frightening minutes while everyone else is still frozen.

This module is short on new theory and long on *doing*. By the end of it you should have a single, written Family Emergency Plan — code words, contacts, meeting points, a go-bag, and a document vault — that every member of your household knows. It draws together the worksheets you filled in across Modules 1 to 7 and turns them into one calm, shared system.



The whole point of a plan: an emergency is the worst possible time to be making decisions for the first time. Everything you decide *now* — calmly, over a quiet evening — is one less thing to work out while your heart is pounding. The plan is not paperwork. It is pre-made calm.

Two families, one emergency

It is 8 p.m. The lights are out, and there is a sudden, hard banging at the gate — voices, urgency, something wrong. In the first home, panic takes over. The children scatter, no one knows where to go, the phones are charging in three different rooms, nobody can remember the estate security number, and precious minutes are lost in pure confusion.

Now the same night in a family with a plan. One word is spoken — their agreed "act now" code word — and everyone moves the way they have practised: the children go straight to the safe room, the steadiest adult grabs the charged phone that lives in a known spot and calls for help, the gate is not opened. Nothing about the danger is smaller. But this family is *acting* while the other is still reeling. That difference — between a plan on paper and a panic in the dark — is what this module is here to build.

Part 1 — The contact tree and the point-person

When something goes wrong, confusion multiplies if everyone is calling everyone. A simple contact tree fixes who reaches whom.

- **Name one calm point-person.** As in Module 6, this is the steadiest adult — often *not* the most emotionally involved one — who takes the lead, makes the key calls, and keeps the family coordinated. Name a backup too, in case the first is the one in trouble.
- **Draw the tree.** Decide, on paper, who calls the police, who calls the rest of the family, who calls the trusted neighbour or estate security. When each person has one clear job, nothing important gets dropped.
- **Agree a single "check-in" contact** outside your home — a relative in another area — who everyone can call to report "I'm safe" if the family gets separated. In many emergencies it is easier to reach someone far away than someone across town.

Part 2 — The emergency numbers card

Memory fails under stress, and a phone may be lost, dead, or taken. Every family member needs the key numbers **on paper**, not only in a contact list.

- **Build one small card** with: **112** (national emergency), your **state police command** line, the local division, a trusted neighbour or estate security, your **point-person**, and your out-of-area check-in contact.

- **Add the practical lifelines** from across this guide: your **bank's 24/7 fraud/card-block line** (Module 7) and your child's school (Module 4).
- **Print several copies** — one for every wallet and school bag, one on the fridge, one in each car, one in the go-bag. Save the same list in every phone, but never *only* in the phone.

Part 3 — All your code words, in one place

Across this playbook you have created several secret words. Module 8 is where you gather them so the whole family is clear — and never confuses one for another.

Code word	What it means	From
"Act now"	Something is wrong — go to the safe room / act immediately, no debate	Module 1
Pickup word	Any adult must know this before a child goes with them	Module 4
Rescue word	A child or relative signalling "come now, no questions, I'm not safe"	Module 4
Family safe word	Confirms "it's really me" — defeats fake-kidnap and AI voice-clone calls	Modules 6 & 7
Proof-of-life question	A question only the real person could answer, agreed in advance	Module 6

Keep these known only to the people who need them, and change any one of them the moment it slips out. Practise

them gently until your children can use them without hesitation.

Part 4 — Meeting points and "what do we do if..."

Families get separated in emergencies — a fire, an attack, a stampede, a phone network that goes down. Agreeing where to regroup removes the terror of not knowing.

- **Pick two meeting points:** one **near home** (a specific neighbour's gate, a particular tree or shop) for something like a fire or a threat inside the house, and one **outside the area** (a relative's house, a known landmark) in case you cannot get back to your street at all.
- **Walk through the key scenarios** as a family, briefly and calmly, so everyone knows their first move:
 - **Intruders inside the house** → go to the safe core, lock it, call 112, do not confront (Module 3).
 - **Fire or evacuation** → get out, do not stop for things, go to the near meeting point, call for help.
 - **A child is lost or doesn't arrive** → act immediately, call 112, go to the school/last-seen place with a photo and last-seen details (Module 4).
 - **Separated in town or network down** → make your way to a meeting point and call the out-of-area check-in contact.
 - **A ransom call** → switch to the Module 6 plan: point-person leads, demand proof of life, go silent online.

Part 5 — The go-bag

A go-bag is one grab-and-run bag, kept somewhere known, that buys your family hours of independence if you must leave fast or sit out a crisis. Keep it simple and check it twice a year.

- **Cash** in small denominations — when networks or POS are down, cash still moves.
- **Photocopies of key IDs** (see the document vault below) in a waterproof pouch.
- **Water and a few non-perishable snacks**; any **essential medication** and a basic first-aid kit.
- **A power bank (charged), a torch, and a whistle** for signalling.
- **A written copy of your emergency numbers card** and a little cash for transport.
- **For families with young children or elderly relatives:** add what *they* specifically need — baby items, spare glasses, a list of medications and dosages.



Get the gear: pre-packed go-bag kits, power banks, torches, first-aid kits, and waterproof document pouches are in the **Recommended Safety Gear** appendix at the back of this book.

Part 6 — The document vault

If anyone ever goes missing, is taken, or you must flee a fire or flood, the right documents at your fingertips save

precious time — and a recent photo of each family member can be the most important thing the police ever ask you for.

- **Keep two copies of everything important:** a **physical set** (a folder or small fireproof safe at home) and a **secure digital set** (scans in an encrypted/cloud folder only you can reach, protected by a strong password — see Module 7).
- **Include:** NIN slips, BVN record, international passports, driver's licences, vehicle papers, property and tenancy documents, insurance, school details, and key medical information (blood groups, allergies, chronic conditions).
- **Add a clear, recent photo of every family member** — including the children — and update them yearly. In a missing-person emergency this is the first thing you will be asked for.
- **Tell your point-person** where both the physical and digital vaults are, so they can reach them if you cannot.



Get the gear: fireproof/waterproof document safes and organiser pouches are in the **Recommended Safety Gear** appendix at the back of this book.

Part 7 — Everyone has a role

A plan only works if each person knows their own small part. Keep each role simple and age-appropriate.

- **Children:** know the code words, the meeting points, how to dial 112, two parent numbers by heart, and "run toward

people and noise." Keep it as calm practice, never as a fear lecture.

- **Spouse and adult relatives:** know the contact tree, who the point-person and backup are, and where the go-bag and document vault live.
- **Elderly or vulnerable relatives:** make sure their medication list is in the go-bag and someone is assigned to help them to the meeting point.
- **Gateman, driver, and domestic staff:** know the gate and visitor rules (Module 3), never share your movements, and know who to alert and how. They are part of your front line.

Part 8 — Drill it (or it isn't real)

A plan you have only *read* is a guess. A plan you have *practised* is a reflex. You do not need a dramatic rehearsal — a calm talk-through is enough.

- **Twice a year, walk the plan through together.** Talk it out at the table; for younger children make it a gentle game ("where do we go if...?", "what's the password?").
- **Practise the small physical moves** that matter: going to the safe room, finding the go-bag in the dark, dialling 112.
- **Update as life changes** — a new baby, a child changing school, a move, a new car, a new phone. Review the plan, refresh the go-bag, and re-check the document vault on the same schedule.

- **Keep the tone calm and capable.** The goal is a family that feels *ready*, not a family that feels afraid. Confidence, not fear, is what a good plan leaves behind.



The one-week challenge. This playbook only protects a family that acts. This week, do four things: agree your code words, write and print your emergency numbers card, pack a basic go-bag, and talk the plan through once with everyone. You can perfect the rest later — but a family that has done just these four is already far safer tonight than it was yesterday.

✓ Module 8 checklist

- ☐ Name your **point-person** and a backup, and draw your contact tree
- ☐ Agree an **out-of-area check-in contact** everyone can call
- ☐ Build, print, and distribute the **emergency numbers card** (wallets, fridge, cars, go-bag)
- ☐ Gather **all your code words** in one place and drill them gently with the family
- ☐ Choose **two meeting points** — one near home, one outside the area
- ☐ Talk through the "what do we do if..." scenarios together
- ☐ Pack and place the **go-bag**, and note where it lives
- ☐ Build the **document vault** — physical + secure digital — with a recent photo of each person
- ☐ Give every household member, including children and staff, their **role**

- ☐ Run one **family drill** this month, and put the next one on the calendar



Worksheet — Our Family Emergency Plan

This is the master page. Fill it in together, then print it and keep it with your emergency card. It pulls together every worksheet in this playbook.

Our point-person, and backup:

Our out-of-area check-in contact:

Key numbers (112, state command, neighbour/estate security, school, bank fraud line):

Our code word — act now:

Our code word — pickup:

Our code word — rescue:

Our family safe word:

Our proof-of-life question (and answer):

Meeting point near home:

Meeting point outside the area:

Where the go-bag lives, and date last checked:

Where the document vault is (physical + digital), and who else knows:

Each person's role (write one line each):

The date of our next family drill:

IN CLOSING

A Final Word

We began this playbook with an honest look at a hard reality, so let us end with something just as true: **you were never powerless, and you are far less so now.**

Look back at how far we have come together. You can read a street and a room the way a professional does. You know how criminals choose, watch, and move — and how to quietly become the target they decide to skip. You have hardened your home in layers, made your daily movements less predictable, thought through the school gate and the open road, prepared your mind for the worst day, locked down your money and your family's life online, and pulled it all into one plan your household can actually use. That is not a small thing. That is a family transformed.

If this playbook has a single heartbeat, it is this: **safety is not fear, and it is not paranoia — it is calm, it is preparation, and above all it is love made practical.** Everything in these pages exists not to make you smaller and more afraid, but to make you freer: free to travel, to do business, to send your children to school, to build the life you want, carrying a quiet confidence instead of a low, constant dread. The aware family is not the tense one. It is the one that has stopped worrying, because it has prepared.

And you do not have to do all of it at once. That was never the point. Pick one thing this week — agree your code words,

walk your fence after dark, save your bank's fraud line, talk the plan through over dinner — and do it. Then another next week. Layer by layer, habit by habit, conversation by conversation, you build something that no single bad day can easily undo. Small, calm, consistent steps are exactly how real safety is made.

Keep this guide close. Return to it when life changes — a new home, a new baby, a new school, a new journey. Share what you have learned with the people you love, gently and without fear. And take real comfort in this: simply by reading to the end, you have already done what most never will. You have chosen to protect your family with open eyes and a steady heart.

Stay aware. Stay prepared. Stay free. And may you and yours never need the hardest chapters in this book.



You've got this. You cannot control everything that happens around you — but you can control how ready your family is for it. That readiness is now in your hands. Use it, share it, and live fully.

Quick-Reference Safety Cards

These ten cards distil the whole playbook into the few moments you will not have time to read. They are built to be **screenshot-worthy and print-ready** — save them to your phone, print them for your wallet, fridge, and car, and share them with your family. Each one stands alone.



Card 1 — Emergency numbers

Fill in the blanks, then save in every phone and print for every wallet, car, and the fridge.

- **112** — National emergency (police, fire, medical — toll-free, all networks)
- **199** — Nigeria Security & Civil Defence Corps (NSCDC)

My state police command: _____

My local police division: _____

Trusted neighbour / estate security: _____

Our family point-person: _____

Out-of-area check-in contact: _____

My bank's 24/7 fraud / card-block line: _____

Children's school: _____



Card 2 — "Am I being followed?" — the 3-turn test

1. **Make three ordinary turns** you'd have no normal reason to take (e.g. three rights back toward where you started).
2. **Still with you after all three?** Treat it as a follow. Don't speed, panic, or confront.
3. **Drive to safety, never home** — nearest police/military post, filling station, bank, or busy, well-lit place.
4. **Call someone and say it out loud:** where you are, where you're heading, the car's colour/type/plate.

Never lead a follower to your gate.



Card 3 — Safe ride-hailing

- ☐ **Match before you enter:** plate + car model/colour + driver photo. Any mismatch → cancel.
- ☐ **Share your live trip** with a trusted contact — every ride.
- ☐ **Stay on-app, always.** Never "go offline," cancel for cash, or take a side deal.
- ☐ **Sit in the back,** behind the front passenger seat.
- ☐ **Watch the map.** Unexplained detours → speak up, call someone, end the trip somewhere busy.
- ☐ **Trust the cancel button** — a bad feeling is reason enough.



Card 4 — ATM safety

- ☐ Use machines **inside a bank, mall, or busy filling station** — daylight only.
- ☐ **Scan before you approach.** Loiterers or a watching car → walk on.
- ☐ **Cover the keypad;** take cash and card quickly.
- ☐ **Never count money in the open** — sort it later, somewhere safe.
- ☐ **Vary your ATMs and times;** don't make one machine a fixed routine.
- ☐ Anyone who follows you out deserves your full attention.



Card 5 — Gate & visitor verification

The one rule: verify before you open — always. Genuine callers will wait; criminals count on your hurry.

- **Say:** *"Please wait outside. I'll confirm and come back to you."*
- **Ask:** Who are you? Which company/station? Who called you, or who are you here to see?
- **Confirm** by calling that office/person on a number you *already have* — never one the visitor gives.
- **No verification, no entry** — not for "officials," "meter readers," "deliveries," or a uniform.
- **Gateman:** never open for strangers on your own, never share the family's movements.



Card 6 — School pickup & code words

- **No code word, no going** — the rule is absolute, no exceptions.
- **Pickup word:** any adult must know it before your child goes with them.
- **Rescue word:** your child's signal for "*come now, no questions*" — using it never gets them in trouble.
- Give the school a **written, photo authorised-pickup list**; they phone you before releasing to anyone else.
- Teach your child: **say no to adults, run toward people and noise, make a scene, dial 112.**
- Vary who collects and when.



Card 7 — Highway travel

- ☐ **Travel by day;** arrive before dark. Never drive lonely highways at night.
- ☐ **Check current road intelligence** for your route before you set off.
- ☐ **Service, fully fuel, check tyres** the day before. Keep the tank above half.
- ☐ **Share route, passengers, and ETA;** agree a halfway and an arrival check-in.
- ☐ **Doors locked, windows up, valuables hidden, gap ahead** in traffic.
- ☐ **Wary of lonely-spot "checkpoints"** — mismatched uniforms, no other traffic.
- ☐ **If carjacked, comply fully.** Your life over the car.



Card 8 — Ransom call: do's & don'ts

DO: stay calm · appoint one point-person · **demand proof of life first** · ask your agreed proof-of-life question · buy time · start a written call log · call **112** · go silent on social media.

DON'T: shout, threaten, or insult · mention the police to the captors · name a large sum first · reveal your true means · rush · pay before confirming the person is alive and truly held.

Fake-kidnap? *If pushed to pay this second and told "don't hang up" — stall, quietly reach the "victim" on another phone, and ask for the family safe word.*



Card 9 — OTP / SIM-swap red flags

- **Never share an OTP, PIN, CVV, or BVN** — no real bank ever asks.
- **Never dial a USSD code** a "helper" gives you.
- **Hang up and call back** on the number on your card — never the one that called you.
- **Sudden dead line** (no calls/texts, "SIM not registered")? Treat as a **SIM-swap emergency** — contact network + bank at once from another phone.
- **Don't click links** in unexpected SMS/WhatsApp/email.
- **"It's me, send money now"**? A safe word beats any cloned voice.



Card 10 — Family Emergency Plan summary

Point-person (and backup): _____

Code word — act now: _____

Code word — pickup: _____

Code word — rescue: _____

Family safe word: _____

Proof-of-life question: _____

Meeting point — near home: _____

Meeting point — outside the area: _____

Out-of-area check-in contact: _____

Go-bag lives at: _____

Document vault: _____

Everyone knows their role; we drill it twice a year.

APPENDIX

Recommended Safety Gear

Throughout this playbook you saw  **Get the gear** pointers. Here is the full list in one place, grouped by module, so your family can shop for everything in one sitting.



How to get the products — and an honest note. We don't sell any of this gear ourselves. We simply point you to trusted listings on **Jumia**, Nigeria's largest store, where most items offer **pay-on-delivery**. Some are affiliate links: if you buy through them we may earn a small commission **at no extra cost to you**, which helps keep this guide updated. To shop, **tap our Jumia link once to activate it — it stays active for 24 hours and covers everything you buy — then search for the items below.**



Tap here to shop on Jumia → Then search the terms below and buy as normal.

The full list, by module

- **Module 1 — Situational awareness:** personal safety alarm, dashcam
- **Module 2 — Daily movement:** dashcam, steering wheel lock, in-car emergency kit
- **Module 3 — Home & estate security:** solar motion lights, solar floodlight, video doorbell, gate intercom, deadbolt

lock, reinforced/security door, solar CCTV kit, inverter/UPS backup, alarm system, panic button, door security bar, power bank

- **Module 4 – Child & school safety:** child GPS tracker/smartwatch, personal safety alarm
- **Module 5 – Vehicle & travel:** GPS vehicle tracker, anti-shatter window film, dashcam, in-car emergency kit
- **Module 6 – If the worst happens:** power bank, document safe/pouch
- **Module 7 – Digital & financial safety:** kid-safe router/device (*parental-control apps come from the Play Store / App Store, not Jumia*)
- **Module 8 – Your family emergency plan:** pre-packed go-bag kit, rechargeable torch, whistle, first-aid kit, fireproof/waterproof document safe

Emergency Contacts Directory

These are current, verifiable national emergency and security contacts, taken from each agency's own official channels. Numbers do change, and lines can be busy or unattended, so treat **112** as your first call and keep the others as backups. Print this page, save every number in your family's phones, and fill in the blanks with your own state and local lines — those are the ones that will reach help fastest where you actually live.



Call this first — 112. Nigeria's national emergency number is toll-free on every network, 24/7, and now the single official line for the whole country. It connects you to police, fire, medical, and disaster response, and the National Counter Terrorism Centre also asks the public to use **112** to report kidnappings and suspicious activity. If you remember only one number in this entire book, remember this one.

National emergency, police & security

Service	Number(s)	What it's for
National Emergency Number	112 (toll-free)	The one line for everything: police, fire, medical, disaster, kidnapping. Always your first call.

Service	Number(s)	What it's for
Nigeria Police Force	112 · 199	Crimes in progress, robbery, threats. If 112 doesn't connect, try 199, then your state command line below.
Police Complaint Response Unit (PCRRU)	0913 333 3785 · 0913 333 3786 (calls) 0805 700 0003 (SMS / WhatsApp)	Report police misconduct, extortion, or to escalate a case that's being ignored. 24/7.
NSCDC (Civil Defence)	199 09 291 4164	Critical-infrastructure, community security, and disaster support; backs up the police.
Road Safety (FRSC)	122 (toll-free) 0700-CALL-FRSC (0700 2255 3772)	Road crashes, highway emergencies, and FRSC ambulance response.
Disaster Mgmt (NEMA)	0800-CALL-NEMA (0800 2255 6362) 112	Floods, fire, building collapse, mass emergencies and disaster response.
Health emergencies (NCDC)	6232 (toll-free) WhatsApp 0708 711 0839 · SMS 0809 955 5577	Disease outbreaks, public-health emergencies, and verified health information.

Financial fraud, scams & cybercrime

Service	Number(s) / Report	What it's for
EFCC (financial crimes)	0809 332 2644 info@efcc.gov.ng · scams: dei@efcc.gov.ng	Fraud, Ponzi and investment scams, advance-fee (419), money laundering. Report fast — speed aids recovery.
Police National Cybercrime Centre (NPF-NCCC)	0916 834 3711 Report: nccc.npf.gov.ng/ereport info@cybercrime.gov.ng	Online fraud, hacking, identity theft, SIM-swap, sextortion, and other cybercrime.
Your bank's 24/7 fraud line	_____ (fill in from your card / bank app)	Freeze your account and block cards the moment you suspect fraud. Save it before you ever need it.

Other national helplines

Service	Number(s)	What it's for
NAPTIP (trafficking & violence against persons)	627 or dial *627# · 0803 0000 203 0800CALLNAPTIP (0800 2255 627874) info@naptip.gov.ng	Human trafficking, child exploitation, and gender-based or domestic violence.
NDLEA drug help & wellness line	0800 1020 3040 (toll-free, 24/7)	Free, confidential support for drug abuse — counselling in English, Pidgin, Hausa, Yoruba, and Igbo.

Lagos State (example — replace with your own state)

Service	Number(s)	What it's for
LASEMA (Lagos emergencies & ambulance)	767 / 112 (toll-free) 0802 288 7777 · 0802 288 3678	Lagos State emergency coordination: accidents, fire, flood, building collapse, ambulance.



Fill in your own local lines — these reach help fastest where you live:

My state police command (control room):

My local police division: _____

My state emergency / ambulance line:

_____ (e.g. Lagos 767/112)

My estate / neighbourhood security or vigilante:

My trusted neighbour: _____

My family point-person & out-of-area check-in:

My bank's 24/7 fraud / card-block line:

My children's school: _____

You can find your state police command's current number on the Nigeria Police Force site (npf.gov.ng) or by calling **112** and asking to be connected.

Sources & Verification

- **National Bureau of Statistics** — Crime Experience and Security Perception Survey 2024 (ransom, kidnapping incidents, household figures).
- **NIBSS (2026 Nigeria Electronic Fraud Forum data); Central Bank of Nigeria; NCC / NCC-CSIRT; EFCC; Nigeria Police Force National Cybercrime Centre; NAPTIP; UNICEF; National Assembly (Child Online Protection Bill, 2025); UNODC & World Economic Forum (2026); Al Jazeera / France24 / Elliptic (CBEX, 2025)** — digital-payment fraud falling 51% to ₦25.85bn in 2025 (from ₦52.26bn in 2024) across roughly 67,515 cases with Lagos at about 63%, aided by BVN–NIN integration; the CBN's 2026 "catastrophic" scam alert on fraudulent links and messages; SIM-swap and social-engineering methods and defences; the OTP/USSD and fake-alert traps; the April 2025 CBEX Ponzi collapse (hundreds of millions of dollars lost across Nigeria and Kenya); romance-scam patterns; the 2026 surge in AI voice-cloning and deepfake impersonation; and child-online-protection guidance, grooming/sextortion risks, and Nigeria's new child online protection law (Module 7).
- **UNICEF** — Kaduna (Kuriga) school abduction response report, 2024 (287 students) (Module 4).
- **Human Rights Watch (World Report 2026); Reuters; BBC; Al Jazeera; AP; OHCHR; Save the Children; CHRICED** — the November 2025 school kidnappings (315 taken at St

Mary's, Papiri, Niger State; 25 schoolgirls seized and the vice-principal killed in Kebbi) and the release of all Papiri captives by Christmas; the continued 2026 surge (OHCHR's January 2026 warning of a new wave of child abductions; over 1,000 Nigerians kidnapped since the start of 2026; a late-April orphanage-school abduction with pupils freed in early May; more than 50 young children seized from three schools in Mussa, Borno; 39 students and 7 teachers taken in Oyo State); at least 816 pupils taken in 22 school attacks since January 2023; more than 1,500 schoolchildren abducted since the 2014 Chibok kidnapping; and roughly 19 million Nigerian children out of school partly due to abduction fears (Module 4).

- **The Conversation; OSAC; ExecSecure; Smartraveller** — "one chance" and express-kidnapping methods (driven between ATMs, usually non-violent unless the victim resists), and ATM safety guidance (Module 2).
- **High Commission of India, Abuja — Security Advisory, Nov 2025; Guardian Nigeria; Springer, *Public transport safety and crime patterns in Lagos and Abuja* (2025)** — rising "one chance"/robbery in Abuja & Lagos, named hotspots, and assaults on passengers (Module 2).
- **TechNext / MEXC e-hailing reviews (2025)** — Bolt's passenger verification and driver-scoring safety features in Nigeria (Module 2).
- **The Guardian Nigeria; Australia Smartraveller; National Bureau of Statistics (2024 Crime Survey); TechCabal (2025)** — property offences as roughly half of reported crime, the prevalence of home invasion/burglary and higher night-time risk, and Nigeria's fast-rising home

CCTV/security-tech adoption with solar/inverter backup (Module 3).

- **U.S. Department of State Nigeria Travel Advisory (Level 3, April 2026) & OSAC; U.S. Embassy Abuja security alerts (Feb 2026); Reuters (Jan 2026); Government of Canada & Australia Smartraveller (May 2026); FRSC** – carjacking, roadside banditry and highway robbery (notably the Abuja–Kaduna corridor, where the army rescued 11 kidnap victims in a January 2026 operation), the "do not travel" states, advice to vary routes and times, avoid night highway travel, and never resist a robbery, plus FRSC stolen-vehicle recovery and road-accident data (Module 5).
- **SBM Intelligence (*The Economics of Nigeria's Kidnap Industry*, 2025); OCCRP; BBC; Reuters; Al Jazeera; Nigeria Police Force / National Counter Terrorism Centre; FBI (IC3); Hostage International** – the scale of kidnap-for-ransom (at least 4,722 people abducted in 997 incidents and 762 killed between July 2024 and June 2025, with roughly ₦48bn demanded and about ₦2.57bn paid; the prior year's 7,500-plus abductions and 1,000-plus deaths); the sobering fact that hostages have been killed even after a ransom was paid; the 2022 law criminalising ransom payment (minimum 15-year term, death penalty where a victim dies); the 112 emergency line and the Multi-Agency Anti-Kidnap Fusion Cell / Special Anti-Kidnapping Squad; the rise of virtual ("fake") kidnapping scams using altered or AI-generated proof-of-life media; and proof-of-life and family-response guidance (Module 6).

- **Jeff Cooper, *Principles of Personal Defense*; Gavin de Becker, *The Gift of Fear*** — the awareness "colour code"/ladder, pre-attack indicators, and trusting instinct (Module 1).
- **GOV.UK, Government of Canada, Australia Smartraveller** — road, traffic, and robbery-response guidance for Nigeria.
- **NCC / NEMSAS** — 112 national emergency number; NSCDC 199.